L3 LEA · S6 ERIC TABUTEAU

Civilisation américaine : publicité et marketing

American Advertising and Marketing: a Printable Workbook

VERSION EXPRESS · UN EXERCICE D'APPLICATION PAR CHAPITRE

6 · 6 EXERCISES

Exercices rédigés pour l'application à partir des fiches du cours ; les situations marquées « fictive » sont inventées. En cas de différence avec le cours de l'enseignant, c'est le cours qui fait foi.

PART 1

The birth of modern advertising: brands, agencies and public relations

EXERCISE 1.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Reason-why or atmosphere? Sorting ad copy

Objective : *Learn to recognize the two rival schools of early American advertising from the text of an ad, and explain the choice.*

Four invented ads, written in the style of the 1900s-1920s, for invented brands. Ad 1, Brightwell Soap: 'Why is Brightwell purer? Because every bar is boiled for eight hours and tested three times. Send this coupon for a free sample.' Ad 2, Monarch Motor Car: 'There is a car that others follow. It does not need to explain itself. Its name is enough.' (Large illustration of the car in front of a mansion, almost no text.) Ad 3, Prairie Oats: 'Each bowl gives you the energy of two eggs, costs less than one cent, and is ready in three minutes.' Ad 4, Velvet Pianos: 'In the homes where music matters most, you will find a Velvet.' (Drawing of an elegant evening party.)

Questions

1. Classify each ad: reason-why or atmosphere. Justify with two clues for each.
2. In ad 1, what is the purpose of the coupon from Claude Hopkins's point of view?
3. Ad 1 describes a process (boiling, testing) that may be common to all soap makers. Which anecdote from Hopkins's career does this recall, and what lesson did he draw from it?
4. Which later opposition of the 1950s-1960s does this rivalry announce?

PART 2

Measuring the audience: Gallup, Nielsen and market research

EXERCISE 2.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Audience and the price of a commercial

Objective : *Apply the principle that audience sets the price of advertising space, through a simple calculation, and choose the right research tool for a marketing question.*

An invented television network sells a 30-second slot in its evening program for $60,000 when the program is watched by 4 million households. Next season, ratings show that the audience has grown to 5 million households, while a second program, at the same hour on the same network, falls from 3 million to 2.4 million households and was priced at $45,000.

PROGRAM	AUDIENCE BEFORE (HOUSEHOLDS)	PRICE BEFORE	AUDIENCE AFTER (HOUSEHOLDS)
Evening program	4,000,000	$60,000	5,000,000
Second program	3,000,000	$45,000	2,400,000

Questions

1. What is the price per thousand households of each program before the change?
2. By what percentage has each audience changed?
3. What should the new price of each slot be if price follows audience?
4. The network also wants to know why viewers left the second program. Should it use Nielsen ratings or qualitative research? Explain.

PART 3

The golden age: television, the USP and the creative revolution

EXERCISE 3.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Two eras, two strategies: USP versus creative revolution

Objective : *Compare a 1950s-style ad and a 1960s-style ad using the criteria of the course (tone, reader, organization, context), and explain Thomas Frank's interpretation.*

Two invented ads for invented washing machines. Ad A (1956): a TV spot sponsored by the brand in its own show, 'The Whirlmax Hour'. A man in a white coat repeats three times: 'Whirlmax washes whiter, because of its double drum. Only Whirlmax has the double drum.' Ad B (1965): a magazine page, mostly white, with a small, slightly old-fashioned machine in a corner. Headline: 'It won't impress your neighbors.' Copy: 'It is not the biggest machine on the market. It will just work for twenty years. Some people prefer that to chrome.'

Questions

1. Fill in a comparison table (tone, reader, organization, real example it resembles) for Ads A and B.
2. Which model of TV advertising does Ad A illustrate, and why did it decline at the end of the 1950s?
3. Why can Ad A be described as a USP ad?
4. Explain how Ad B illustrates Thomas Frank's notion of hip consumerism.

PART 4

Regulation: the FTC, commercial speech and tobacco

EXERCISE 4.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

A deceptive claim before the FTC

Objective : *Apply the FTC's tools (deceptive practices, substantiation, corrective advertising, endorsement disclosure) to an invented case.*

An invented company, PureBreath, sells a throat spray in the United States. Its TV commercials claim: 'PureBreath stops the flu before it starts.' The company has no study supporting this claim. After several complaints, the FTC opens an investigation. Meanwhile, the brand's marketing director suggests three ideas: (1) keep the claim but say it in smaller letters; (2) replace it with 'PureBreath freshens your throat for six hours', supported by a test; (3) pay a well-known singer to praise the spray on social media without mentioning the payment.

Questions

1. On what legal basis can the FTC act, and what will it ask PureBreath to provide?
2. Which remedy, used in a real case from the course, could the FTC impose? Explain the precedent.
3. Evaluate the director's three ideas.
4. Would the FDA or the FTC be the general authority on this advertisement? Why?

PART 5

The contemporary era: segmentation and digital advertising

EXERCISE 5.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Running a digital campaign: costs, conversions and legal limits

Objective : *Compute CPM, CPC and conversion figures for a digital campaign and identify the legal issues of targeting in the United States.*

Stride (invented brand) runs two online campaigns for a running shoe. Campaign 1, programmatic display paid per thousand impressions: 500,000 impressions at a CPM of $8; it produces 8,000 clicks and 240 purchases. Campaign 2, search ads paid per click on the keyword 'marathon shoes': 5,000 clicks at a CPC of $0.60; it produces 200 purchases. Stride's team also suggests: (a) targeting users who visited running websites, through cookies; (b) a campaign on a game app used mostly by children aged 10 to 12, collecting their data; (c) paying runners on social media to post about the shoe.

Questions

1. Compute the total cost of each campaign.
2. Compute the conversion rate of each campaign.
3. Compute the cost per purchase and say which campaign is more efficient.
4. Comment on ideas (a), (b) and (c) from a legal and ethical point of view.

PART 6

Method: analyzing an advertisement

EXERCISE 6.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Full analysis of an advertisement

Objective : *Apply the seven steps of the method to an invented ad and write a structured analysis that links technique, context and critical interpretation.*

Use the Morning Star ad from exercise cva-12 (invented, 1957). Then compare it with a second invented ad for the same brand, 1966: a full white page, a small chipped cup in a corner, the headline 'Our coffee won't save your marriage.' The copy says: 'But it will be ready in ten seconds, which leaves you more time to argue about something else.' Logo and tagline unchanged.

Questions

1. Identify both ads and give the presumed target of each, with a justification.
2. Trace the AIDA path in the 1957 ad.
3. To which advertising style does each ad belong? Justify with two criteria from the course.
4. What does the 1957 ad reveal about society, and what does it leave out?
5. Write a three-part plan and a full introduction for the analysis of the two ads.

Explained answer key

Exercise 1.1 · Reason-why or atmosphere? Sorting ad copy

1. 1. Ad 1: reason-why (a question answered with because, precise facts: eight hours, three tests; a coupon). Ad 2: atmosphere (no argument, the car's prestige and status, a large image, it does not need to explain itself, in the spirit of MacManus's Cadillac ad). Ad 3: reason-why (three concrete, measurable benefits: energy, price, time). Ad 4: atmosphere (social prestige, an elegant scene, no fact about the piano itself).
2. 2. For Hopkins, advertising must be measured: a reply coupon shows how many readers responded to this particular ad, so the advertiser can test different versions and keep the most effective. This is the core of his Scientific Advertising (1923).
3. 3. It recalls the Schlitz beer story: Hopkins described how the bottles were washed with live steam, a process common to all brewers. His lesson: the first to explain a fact makes it his own in the public's eyes. Ad 1 uses the same idea.
4. 4. The course says the two schools would resurface in the opposition between the USP (Rosser Reeves, a single repeated rational argument) and the creative revolution of the 1960s (image, humor, complicity). Final result: reason-why argues with facts (salesmanship in print); atmosphere suggests through image and prestige.

Traps to avoid : Thinking that an ad with a picture is automatically atmosphere: what counts is whether the message gives reasons or suggests status and emotion. · Attributing salesmanship in print to Hopkins: the formula is John E. Kennedy's, adopted by Lasker in 1904. · Calling the atmosphere school irrational or useless: it is a different persuasion strategy.

Exercise 2.1 · Audience and the price of a commercial

1. 1. Evening program: 60,000 / 4,000 = $15 per thousand households. Second program: 45,000 / 3,000 = $15 per thousand households. Both slots are priced at the same rate per thousand households reached.
2. 2. Evening program: (5,000,000 - 4,000,000) / 4,000,000 = +25%. Second program: (2,400,000 - 3,000,000) / 3,000,000 = -20%.
3. 3. Evening program: 60,000 x 1.25 = $75,000. Second program: 45,000 x 0.80 = $36,000. Check: 75,000 / 5,000 = $15 and 36,000 / 2,400 = $15 per thousand households: the rate is unchanged, only the audience has moved, which confirms the calculation.
4. 4. Ratings tell the network how many households are watching, not why they left. To understand reasons, it needs qualitative research (interviews, groups), possibly combined with a representative opinion survey. Final result: $75,000 and $36,000; audience measurement is the currency of the advertising market, but understanding behavior requires other tools.

Traps to avoid : Computing the change in percentage from the new audience instead of the old one. · Adding the percentage to the price per thousand instead of to the total price. · Thinking that audience figures explain viewers' motives.

Exercise 3.1 · Two eras, two strategies: USP versus creative revolution

1. 1. Ad A: serious, repetitive, insistent tone; a reader to be convinced through repetition; copywriter and designer working separately (the 1950s organization); it resembles M&M's or Anacin. Ad B: humor, irony, self-deprecation; an intelligent, complicit reader; a creative team (copywriter plus art director, Bernbach's innovation) visible in the way text and white space work together; it resembles Volkswagen Think Small (1959) and Avis We try harder (1962), which turned a weakness into a selling point.
2. 2. Sponsorship: one advertiser finances and controls a whole program that bears its name. After the quiz show scandals (1958-1959), which discredited advertisers' control of programs, the networks took back control of programming and sold spots to several advertisers.
3. 3. Because it makes one concrete proposition (washes whiter), presents it as unique (only Whirlmax has the double drum) and repeats it relentlessly, as Rosser Reeves recommended.
4. 4. Ad B invites the reader to feel smarter than neighbors who are impressed by chrome: buying this machine becomes a way of rejecting conformism. According to Frank, the creative revolution co-opted the codes of the counterculture (nonconformism, irony) to sell; the rebellion itself becomes a selling argument. Final result: the USP hammers one argument; the creative revolution seduces through complicity, and, for Frank, turns nonconformism into consumption.

Traps to avoid : Saying that the creative revolution was part of the counterculture: according to Frank, advertising appropriated its codes rather than belonging to it. · Dating the move from sponsorship to spots to the 1970s: it followed the quiz show scandals of 1958-1959. · Describing the ads without using the comparison criteria.

Exercise 4.1 · A deceptive claim before the F'TC

1. 1. The Wheeler-Lea Act (1938) extended the FTC's powers to unfair or deceptive acts or practices toward consumers. Under the substantiation doctrine (1972), PureBreath must back up its claim with evidence; it has none, so the claim is deceptive.
2. 2. Corrective advertising. In the Listerine case, the FTC ordered the company in 1975 (upheld on appeal in 1977) to correct its claim that the mouthwash prevented colds. PureBreath's claim about the flu is very similar: the FTC could require future ads to correct the false belief created.
3. 3. Idea 1: no; a false claim in small letters remains false and unsupported. Idea 2: yes; the claim is concrete and backed up by a test, so it meets the substantiation requirement. Idea 3: no; the FTC requires paid partnerships with influencers to be disclosed (Endorsement Guides).
4. 4. The FTC, because it is the general authority on deceptive advertising; the FDA deals with food and drugs themselves. Final result: deceptive claim (Wheeler-Lea), lack of substantiation, risk of corrective advertising as for Listerine; only a supported claim and disclosed partnerships are acceptable.

Traps to avoid : Thinking that the First Amendment protects false advertising: commercial speech is protected within limits, and deceptive claims can be prosecuted. · Forgetting that the burden of proof is on the advertiser (substantiation). · Treating an undisclosed paid post as simple free speech by the singer.

Exercise 5.1 · Running a digital campaign: costs, conversions and legal limits

1. 1. Campaign 1: 500,000 / 1,000 = 500 thousands of impressions; 500 x $8 = $4,000. Campaign 2: 5,000 x $0.60 = $3,000.
2. 2. Campaign 1: 240 / 8,000 = 0.03, i.e. 3%. Campaign 2: 200 / 5,000 = 0.04, i.e. 4%.
3. 3. Campaign 1: 4,000 / 240 = about $16.67 per purchase. Campaign 2: 3,000 / 200 = $15.00 per purchase. Campaign 2 is more efficient: it costs less in total, converts better and each sale costs less. This is logical: people searching for marathon shoes have already expressed an intention to buy.
4. 4. (a) Cookies are only the means of collection; the issue is the personal data gathered (browsing behavior) and privacy, the core of what Zuboff calls surveillance capitalism. In the United States there is no general federal law like the GDPR, but state laws such as California's regulate collection. (b) COPPA (1998) protects the data of children under 13: collecting data from 10- to 12-year-olds is regulated and raises strong ethical concerns. (c) Allowed only if the paid partnership is disclosed, as the FTC requires (Endorsement Guides). Final result: $4,000 and $3,000; 3% and 4%; about $16.67 and $15.00 per purchase; precise measurement must go together with respect for data and disclosure rules.

Traps to avoid : Multiplying impressions directly by the CPM, without dividing by 1,000 (which would give $4,000,000). · Calculating the conversion rate on impressions instead of clicks. · Comparing campaigns on total cost only, instead of cost per purchase. · Saying that the United States has a GDPR-like federal law.

Exercise 6.1 · Full analysis of an advertisement

1. 1. Ad 1: Morning Star instant coffee, magazine ad, 1957; presumed target: housewives, because the copy invokes 1,000 housewives and the headline (Ready before he is) puts the woman in the position of the one who serves. Ad 2: same brand, magazine, 1966; presumed target: adult readers, men and women, who enjoy irony; the copy addresses a couple. We say presumed because we infer the target from the document.
2. 2. Attention: the headline Ready before he is and the image of the smiling couple. Interest: the body copy explains how the product works (one spoonful, hot water, seconds). Desire: the image of comfort and a harmonious home, plus the reassurance of the 1,000 testers. Action: Ask your grocer today.
3. 3. Ad 1 resembles the 1950s style: serious tone, a single, concrete benefit (speed) presented insistently, a reader to be convinced. Ad 2 belongs to the creative revolution: self-deprecation (it won't save your marriage), a white page and a small object as in Think Small, humor and complicity with an intelligent reader who is not taken in by big promises.
4. 4. It reflects a gendered division of roles: the woman at home in an apron, the man in a suit leaving for work; the car and lawn express postwar prosperity and the values of family and success. It leaves out women who work, single people, and any household that does not match the white suburban ideal; nothing is said about cost or the quality of the coffee compared with other brands.
5. 5. Plan: I. Two ads, one product: composition and persuasion (headline, visual, copy; logos, ethos, pathos; AIDA). II. From the 1950s to the creative revolution: two advertising schools (insistence and promise versus irony and complicity). III. What the ads say about society: gender roles, prosperity, and the co-opting of irony (Thomas Frank's hip consumerism). Introduction: These two invented magazine advertisements for Morning Star instant coffee, published in 1957 and 1966, promote the same product to American households. The first relies on the image of a devoted housewife and a promise of speed, while the second adopts the ironic, self-deprecating tone of the 1960s. Comparing them shows how the persuasive techniques of American advertising changed between the 1950s and the creative revolution, and what each reveals about gender roles and consumer values. We will first analyze their composition and persuasive strategies, then place them in their advertising context, before interpreting the representations they convey. Final result: identify, describe, interpret, contextualize, criticize, always linking technique to meaning.

Traps to avoid : Describing the ads at length without interpreting them: description is only one step. · Forgetting the context (period, advertising school), which explains the change of tone. · Judging the 1957 ad with present-day values only, without first explaining it in its context. · Forgetting to analyze what the ad leaves out.

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